Name: _____ **Group:** _____ **Date:** _____

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PRO

Learning Path 3 · Where traditions come from

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

🎯 My goal

Before you start: think about your last recall or checkpoint. What do you want to get better at in this Learning Path?

_____

1 Recall: Learning Paths 1 and 2

Type the answers without looking. Collocations, word formation and emphasis from the last Learning Paths.

1. Today's Halloween is a far _____ from the Celtic festival.
2. The town is steeped _____ tradition.
3. The mixing of religions into one tradition: s_____
4. Some complain about the _____ (COMMERCIAL) of Christmas.
5. Never _____ I seen such a crowd. (1 word)
6. No sooner had the bells rung _____ the fireworks began.
7. _____ I love most about Diwali is the lamps. (1 word)
8. With all the lists and shopping, I feel as _____ I need a holiday.

2 C2 vocabulary: origins and change

Explore, go through the cards and complete the sentences. These words let you talk about how traditions begin, change and survive.

English	Meaning	Example
Origins		
stem from	to come from or be caused by something	The custom stems from a harvest ritual.
be rooted in	to have its origin or basis in something	Halloween is rooted in Samhain.
give rise to	to cause something to begin	Irish emigration gave rise to the pumpkin lantern.
date back to	to have existed since a time in the past	The fair dates back to the 1300s.
folklore	traditional beliefs and stories of a community	In local folklore, the spirits return that night.
an invented tradition	a custom presented as ancient but actually quite recent	Many "ancient" Christmas customs are invented traditions.
Change		
evolve into	to develop gradually into something different	A solemn vigil evolved into a street party.
morph into	to change gradually into something else (informal)	Halloween has morphed into a shopping event.

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English	Meaning	Example
supplant	to take the place of something older	Pumpkins supplanted turnips.
fall into disuse	to stop being used or practised	The custom fell into disuse after the war.
revive	to make something popular or active again	A local group revived the old dance.
dwindle	to become gradually smaller or fewer	The number of people who observe the fast has dwindled.
sanitise	to make something less unpleasant or controversial by removing parts of it	School plays often sanitise the Thanksgiving story.
Attitudes		
nostalgic	remembering the past with pleasure and some sadness	My grandmother is nostalgic about the old Castanyada.
sceptical	having doubts about something	Historians are sceptical of the popular version.
contested	argued about; not accepted by everyone	The meaning of Thanksgiving is contested.
reverent	showing deep respect	a reverent silence
irreverent	not showing the expected respect, often in a funny way	an irreverent take on Christmas

Words you will hear or read (no need to learn them): antiquarian · revivalist · palimpsest · vestigial · Christianised

Study them: cover the meaning column and define each word in your own words. Then complete the sentences without looking at the table.

Complete the sentences

1. The Halloween lantern _____ from an Irish custom of carving turnips.
2. In America, pumpkins soon _____ turnips because they were easier to carve.
3. The old dance fell into _____ but was revived in the 1980s.
4. Irish emigration gave _____ to the Halloween we know today.
5. The number of families who observe the full ritual has _____ to a handful. (became smaller)
6. Many school plays _____ the story of the first Thanksgiving. (make it less unpleasant)
7. The meaning of the holiday is _____: not everyone agrees on it.
8. Historians are _____ (SCEPTIC) about the popular version of the story.
9. A custom that looks ancient but is actually recent is an _____ tradition.
10. Halloween is rooted _____ the Celtic festival of Samhain.

3 Listening: The story behind two autumn celebrations

The same podcast as your class, with C2 Proficiency Listening questions (Parts 1 and 3): purpose, attitude and what the speakers imply. Listen once, read the questions, then listen again.

🎧 **Culture Bites: the story behind two autumn celebrations** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

1. Why does Sam introduce the turnips with “here’s a surprise”?

   a) He thinks turnips are a strange food. **b)** He wants to change the subject to food.

   c) He is not sure the information is correct.

   d) He expects listeners to assume pumpkins were always part of Halloween.

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2. What does the change from turnips to pumpkins illustrate in the podcast?
   a) how Celtic beliefs were forgotten **b)** how a tradition adapts when people move to a new place
   c) how expensive the festival has become **d)** how children changed the festival
3. What is Emma's purpose when she says "But it didn't become a national holiday until 1863"?
   a) to explain why the date changes every year
   b) to correct the idea that the holiday began in its present form in 1621
   c) to show that Thanksgiving is older than Halloween **d)** to criticise President Lincoln
4. When Emma mentions that some Native Americans see Thanksgiving as a day of mourning, her tone is best described as…
   a) careful and fair **b)** doubtful about the facts **c)** humorous **d)** angry and accusing
5. What does the phrase "not everybody sees the story in the same way" imply?
   a) Most people have never heard the story. **b)** The story changes from family to family.
   c) Historians have proved the story is false.
   d) The usual version of the story leaves out other points of view.
6. Which statement best expresses the speakers' final conclusion?
   a) Both festivals began with the harvest but have been transformed over time.
   b) Halloween has changed more than Thanksgiving. **c)** Both festivals have kept their original meaning.
   d) Modern celebrations are less meaningful than old ones.
7. How would you describe the register of the podcast?
   a) casual, with no factual content **b)** formal and official
   c) informal but informative, aimed at a general audience **d)** academic, aimed at specialists

4 Listening chart: how speakers show what matters

Watch both videos. At C2 you are expected to notice not just what speakers value, but how they show it: stories, contrasts, humour, a change of tone.

🎧 **Video 1 · Mei: Lunar New Year** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 2 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

🎧 **Video 2 · Noah: Hanukkah** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 3 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

Mei: what does she really value, and which detail reveals it (not the one she says directly)?

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Noah: what does he value, and what does the story he has heard “a hundred times” do in his talk?

One technique each speaker uses to make the listener care (humour, contrast, a personal detail…)

In two sentences: what do the two celebrations have in common at a deeper level?

Self-assessment

Circle: 1 Not yet · 2 Partly · 3 Mostly · 4 Fully

5 Real video: the history of Halloween

A short National Geographic documentary at native speed, with a narrator and a historian. Listen for how they interpret the history, not only for the facts: several questions ask about attitude and word choice.

🎧 **Halloween History** · YouTube video: your teacher will play it for you (youtube.com/watch?v=R-VRAemIvbI).

1. Why does the narrator describe Halloween as a “patchwork” holiday?
   a) People make their own costumes from old clothes.
   b) It is made up of many different cultural, religious and occult traditions stitched together.
   c) It has changed its date many times. **d)** It is celebrated differently in every village.
2. For the Celts, what made 31 October special?
   a) It was the only day without work. **b)** It was the longest night of the year.
   c) It was the end of the harvest and of the year, when the boundary between the living and the dead was thinnest.
   d) It was the day the Romans arrived.
3. What were the huge bonfires for?
   a) To cook the last of the harvest **b)** To keep the village warm all winter
   c) To drive the spirits of the dead back to their world **d)** To guide travellers home
4. How does the historian interpret the Church’s decision to place All Saints’ Day on 1 November?
   a) As a deliberate strategy to draw pagans into the Church **b)** As a gift to the Celtic kings
   c) As a coincidence of the calendar **d)** As a way to ban Samhain completely

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5. Where does the word “Halloween” come from?
   a) An old English word for ghost **b)** A Celtic word for bonfire
   c) All Hallows’ Eve, the night before All Saints’ Day **d)** The name of an Irish village
6. How did Halloween reach America?
   a) With Spanish missionaries **b)** With the first English settlers in 1620
   c) With Irish immigrants escaping the Potato Famine in the 1840s
   d) Through American films in the 1930s
7. Why did early pranksters wear masks?
   a) So that nobody would recognise them **b)** To scare away evil spirits **c)** To keep warm
   d) Because it was the law
8. What is the speakers’ attitude to the origins of trick-or-treating?
   a) Wry: they present it as something close to a protection racket, with treats as bribes.
   b) Disapproving: they think it should be banned. **c)** Nostalgic: they miss the old version.
   d) Neutral: they give no interpretation.

6 Shadowing · Culture Bites: the story behind two autumn celebrations

Repeat part of the listening just behind the speaker, like a shadow.

How it works
Your teacher plays the clip three times: first read while you listen, then mumble the words along, then say them aloud just behind the speaker.

Emma: Now, Thanksgiving. It takes place on the fourth Thursday of November, and this year that’s the twenty-sixth.

Sam: The story usually starts in 1621. A group of English settlers, the Pilgrims, had a harvest feast with the Wampanoag people, who lived in the area. It lasted three days.

Emma: But it didn’t become a national holiday until 1863, when President Abraham Lincoln made it official.

Sam: Today families travel home, get together and share a big meal, usually with turkey. Many people say what they are grateful for.

7 Talking about the past at C2: reporting, would, participle clauses

Key word transformations (Reading and Use of English, Part 4). Complete the second sentence with 3–8 words, including the word in CAPITALS.

How it works
Impersonal reporting for uncertain history: *It is believed that… · Halloween is thought to have originated in… · The custom is said to date back to…* (perfect infinitive for the past).
would for repeated past actions (not states): *On that night, people would light bonfires.* **used to** for both.
Participle clauses to compress: *Having moved to America, Irish families… · Carved from turnips, the first lanterns…*
Exam tip: reporting transformations almost always need the perfect infinitive (*to have + past participle*) when the action is in the past.

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1. People believe that Halloween began in Ireland. THOUGHT → Halloween _____ in Ireland.
2. People say the festival dates back to Celtic times. SAID → The festival _____ back to Celtic times.
3. It is reported that the first feast lasted three days. REPORTED → The first feast _____ three days.
4. Every year my grandfather lit the first bonfire. WOULD → Every year my grandfather _____ the first bonfire.
5. After they had moved to America, Irish families started carving pumpkins. HAVING → _____ to America, Irish families started carving pumpkins.
6. Thanksgiving did not become official until 1863. ONLY → It was _____ Thanksgiving became official.
7. The tradition has almost disappeared. VERGE → The tradition is _____ disappearing.
8. It is possible that the custom came from Scotland. MAY → The custom _____ from Scotland.
9. People no longer carve turnips. LONGER → Turnips _____ carved.
10. The festival changed a lot because of emigration. RESULT → The festival changed a lot _____ emigration.

8 Word formation: Inventing tradition

Reading and Use of English, Part 3: form a word from the word in CAPITALS to fit each gap. Check the part of speech, the prefix (often negative) and the plural.

How it works

Many customs we think of as ancient are, in fact, (1) ___ (SURPRISE) recent. The historian Eric Hobsbawm called them “invented traditions”: practices that claim (2) ___ (CONTINUE) with the past but were created to give a group a sense of (3) ___ (BELONG). The Scottish kilt in its modern form, for example, owes more to the nineteenth century than to any (4) ___ (ANCESTOR) clan custom. None of this makes such traditions (5) ___ (MEANING). Their (6) ___ (ATTRACT) lies precisely in the fact that they feel old, and the (7) ___ (WILLING) of people to embrace them says a great deal about our need for roots. Critics who dismiss them as mere (8) ___ (FABRICATE) miss the point.

1. (1) SURPRISE

2. (2) CONTINUE

3. (3) BELONG

4. (4) ANCESTOR

5. (5) MEANING

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6. (6) ATTRACT

7. (7) WILLING

8. (8) FABRICATE

9 Piece 2: essay (C2 Proficiency Writing, Part 1)

This text is the second piece of your final product. In Part 1 you summarise and evaluate two short texts in an essay.

Your task

Read the two extracts. Write an **essay** (240–280 words) summarising and evaluating the key points of both texts. Use your own words throughout, and include your own ideas in your answer. Use your group's celebration as an example in your evaluation.

Text 1. Traditions that refuse to change die. The festivals that thrive today are those that have absorbed new music, new foods and new people, often to the dismay of purists. To demand that a celebration be preserved exactly as it was is, in effect, to ask for it to be put in a museum: admired, perhaps, but no longer lived.

Text 2. Not all change is adaptation; much of it is simple erosion. When a festival is reshaped by marketing departments and tourist boards, it may gain visitors while losing the very thing that made it worth visiting. A community that no longer recognises its own celebration has not updated a tradition. It has sold one.

Model (don't copy it)

Structure only. Paragraph 1: the shared issue in one sentence, then Text 1's point in your words. · Paragraph 2: Text 2's point, linked as a contrast (*Text 2, by contrast, draws a distinction between…*). · Paragraph 3: your evaluation of each, with your group's celebration as evidence. · Paragraph 4: your position, which may combine both (*The real test, perhaps, is who drives the change*).

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10 Speaking: plan a long turn (no recording)

The question

Should a celebration be allowed to lose its original meaning?

Ideas on the card: commercialisation · different groups, different meanings · keeping traditions alive

C2 Proficiency Speaking, Part 3: two minutes alone on a question, then a discussion. Here you plan it.

🧭 Strategy

Strategy · define before you argue. Strong C2 answers often start by questioning a word in the question. Here: what is the “original” meaning, and who decides? (Halloween’s Samhain? Thanksgiving’s 1621 or 1863?) This gives you a position instantly and shows range.

Then use “yes, but”: give the side you disagree with its best version first, then turn it. Examiners hear this as maturity, not indecision.

Buying time without sounding hesitant: *That’s a question that depends on what we mean by… · Let me come at that from a slightly different angle…*

Your plan · Write notes, not full sentences: this is the thinking you would do in the exam’s preparation time.

What comes to mind first? (15 seconds, everything)

Which word in the question would you challenge, and how?

Your two strongest ideas, and the example for each (from this Learning Path or your life)

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Your order: the challenged word → the other side's best case → your turn → conclusion

A model plan

(read it only after you have written your plan)

Challenge the word: "original" is slippery: Halloween's original meaning was Samhain; the pumpkin version is itself a change.
The other side's best case: when meaning goes, a festival becomes a shopping season (Halloween costumes in September).
My turn: meanings have always shifted; what matters is whether the community still recognises itself in it. Thanksgiving shows the risk: one group's celebration, another's day of mourning.
Conclusion: a celebration may change its meaning, but not by erasing the people it belonged to.

Notice how the example from the podcast is used as evidence in two different places, and how the conclusion is a condition, not a yes or no.

What would you change in your plan now? (one sentence)

11 Talk: where does it come from?

A teammate asks you about the celebration your group is researching.

Your task

Answer in detail. Compare the past and the present, give your opinion and contrast ideas with although or while.

1. **Which celebration is your group researching?**
2. **When do people celebrate it?**
3. **What do people do?**

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4. **Where does it come from?**

5. **What did people use to do in the past?**

6. **Is it older than Halloween?**

7. **How has it changed, and do you think the change is good?**

Then · Have the conversation aloud with a classmate: they ask and you answer, then swap.

Model

We're researching Hanukkah, which is the Jewish festival of lights. It lasts eight nights, usually in December. Families light one more candle on the menorah every evening, and grandparents often tell the old story of the oil that burned for eight days in Jerusalem. It's about two thousand years old, so it's older than Halloween. Although the story is very old, some things have changed: now there are big public menorahs in city squares, and many families give presents. I think that's good, because more people learn about it.

🔁 **How did it go?**

What helped me most?

What do I need to review?

📚 Study guide: prepare for Checkpoint 2 and the final exam

How to study what you learn in this Learning Path, and practice that works like the checkpoint and looks like the exam. The answer key is at the end of each activity.

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How to study

🧠 Test yourself, don't reread

Close your notes and try to remember: write the words, say the rule, answer the questions. Then check. Rereading and highlighting feel useful, but you remember much less.

Retrieval practice · Roediger & Karpicke 2006; Dunlosky et al. 2013

📅 Spread it out

Three short sessions of 15 minutes on different days work better than one long session the day before.

Spacing · Cepeda et al. 2006

🔀 Mix it up

Practise similar things together so you learn to choose the right one for each sentence.

Interleaving · Rohrer & Taylor 2007

✅ Check and fix at once

Mark your answers with the key straight away and write each wrong answer again, correctly.

Feedback · Hattie & Timperley 2007

💬 Say why

For every answer, say the reason: "on, because it's a date." Explaining makes the rule stick.

Self-explanation · Dunlosky et al. 2013

😴 Sleep on it

Your brain stores what you learn while you sleep. A short self-test and a good night's sleep beat studying late the night before.

Sleep and memory · Diekelmann & Born 2010

My plan

1. **Today** · Close this page and write from memory: five new words and one example of used to, whereas and where. Then check.
2. **In 2–3 days** · Do "Practise for Checkpoint 2" below. Look at the key and write again what you got wrong.
3. **Before Checkpoint 2** · Go over the flashcards: only the ones you still miss.
4. **The week before the exam** · Do the exam-style practice in every Learning Path, then the Sample exam. Repeat only the parts you failed.

What comes up

Checkpoint 2 (LS1 and Learning Paths 1–3): short gaps, collocations and word formation, one question at a time, about 45 seconds each, no going back and no notes. You do it once, and you must stay on the page: if you leave it, it is sent. It opens the next Learning Path.
Final exam: the C2 version: listening for attitude and implication, a long reading, vocabulary (multiple-choice cloze and word formation), grammar (open cloze and key word transformations) and a formal letter.

Practise for Checkpoint 2

One question at a time · 45 s

It works like the real checkpoint: 10 questions, one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back and no notes. This is only practice: nothing is sent, you can repeat it, and at the end you see your answers and the key.

On paper: cover the questions and uncover them one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back.

1. Today's Thanksgiving bears little _____ to the feast of 1621.
2. Pumpkins soon took the _____ of turnips.

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3. The festival _____ its origins to a Celtic ritual.
4. The custom fell _____ disuse in the 1900s.
5. The holiday was _____ (OFFICIAL) recognised in 1863.
6. Not until 1863 _____ Thanksgiving become a national holiday.
7. My grandfather _____ tell us ghost stories every Halloween. (past habit, 1 word)
8. Some customs have stood the test of _____.
9. _____ (ARGUE), Halloween is now more American than Irish.
10. The story is usually told _____ the point of view of the settlers.

Like the exam: Listening

4 × 2 points

Listen to the recording from this Learning Path once without the questions. Then read the questions and listen again.

🎧 The recording from this Learning Path · if you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end.

1. What is the main purpose of the podcast? [2 points]

a) to persuade listeners to celebrate Thanksgiving **b)** to compare Irish and American food
c) to show how two celebrations began and changed **d)** to criticise Halloween

2. Emma's reaction "Turnips?" mainly expresses… [2 points]

a) surprise **b)** boredom **c)** disagreement **d)** anger

3. When Sam says "the tradition changed", he is referring to… [2 points]

a) the end of the harvest **b)** the switch from turnips to pumpkins **c)** the date of Halloween
d) the belief in spirits

4. The closing line "Happy holidays!" is best described as… [2 points]

a) a light, friendly sign-off **b)** an invitation to a party **c)** an ironic comment **d)** a correction of Sam

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right word, or type it.

1. The custom ___ back to the Middle Ages. [1 point]

a) roots **b)** traces **c)** dates **d)** steps

2. Irish emigrants ___ the tradition with them to America. [1 point]

a) fetched **b)** brought **c)** held **d)** led

3. The holiday has a _____ (CONTROVERSY) meaning for some Native Americans. [2 points]

4. The story of the first Thanksgiving has been _____ (ROMANCE) over the centuries. [2 points]

Like the exam: Grammar

1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right form, or type it.

1. People believe the Pilgrims held the feast in 1621. BELIEVED → The Pilgrims _____ the feast in 1621. [2 points]

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2. My grandmother always made pumpkin soup on 31 October. WOULD → My grandmother _____ pumpkin soup on 31 October. [2 points]

3. Open cloze: _____ having started as a harvest festival, Thanksgiving is now mostly about family. [2 points]

4. Open cloze: It was not _____ 1863 that the holiday became official. [2 points]

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📚 Study guide: answer key

Look at them only when you have finished each activity.

Practise for Checkpoint 2

1. **resemblance** · bear little resemblance to.
2. **place** · take the place of.
3. **owes** · owe / trace its origins to.
4. **into** · fall into disuse.
5. **officially** · official → officially.
6. **did** · Not until… + inversion.
7. **would** · would for past habits.
8. **time** · stand the test of time.
9. **arguably** · argue → arguably.
10. **from** · from the point of view of.

Like the exam: Listening

1. **to show how two celebrations began and changed** · The whole episode traces origins and change.
2. **surprise** · A short echo question = surprise.
3. **the switch from turnips to pumpkins** · Pumpkins were bigger and easier to carve.
4. **a light, friendly sign-off** · It simply ends the episode warmly.

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1. **dates** · date back to.
2. **brought** · bring something with you.
3. **controversial** · controversy → controversial.
4. **romanticised** · romance → romanticise.

Like the exam: Grammar

1. **are believed to have held** · are believed to have + past participle.
2. **would make** · would for past habits.
3. **despite** · Despite + -ing.
4. **until** · It was not until… that…

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Transcripts (only if you cannot listen)

Transcript 1 · Culture Bites: the story behind two autumn celebrations

Transcript 2 · Video 1 · Mei: Lunar New Year

Mei: Hi! I'm Mei. I'm fifteen and I live in Manchester. My favourite celebration is Lunar New Year. It usually takes place in late January or February. A few days before, we clean the whole flat to sweep away bad luck. My brother hates that part! On New Year's Eve, my grandparents come from Liverpool and we have a huge reunion dinner. We make dumplings together, all of us around the kitchen table. For me, that's the best moment. Everybody is talking and laughing, and nobody is looking at their phone. Then the children get red envelopes with money, and we go to Chinatown to watch the dragon dance. It's so loud and colourful! Not every family celebrates it in the same way. But for us, it's about being together and starting the year with good luck.

Transcript 3 · Video 2 · Noah: Hanukkah

Noah: Hello, I'm Noah. I'm sixteen and I'm from London. My family celebrates Hanukkah, the Jewish festival of lights. It lasts eight nights, usually in December. Every evening, we light one more candle on the menorah. And my grandmother always tells the old story: a tiny bit of oil burned for eight days in the Temple in Jerusalem. I've heard that story maybe a hundred times, but I still love it, because it connects us to people who lived more than two thousand years ago. We eat latkes, which are potato pancakes cooked in oil, and doughnuts. And my little sister always wins at dreidel. She says it's just luck! For me, Hanukkah is about remembering where we come from. And it's about hope: one small light can make a dark winter evening feel brighter.

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